



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

It's Friday the 13th!



Learning Outcome

Describe complicated or unusual events in the past through a wider range of B1 language in both work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- Do you believe Friday the 13th is a bad luck day? Why or why not?
- Do you avoid doing any activities on this day? Which ones?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about manners, customs and superstitions.
- I can talk about my attitudes toward an action.
- I can talk about things I am supposed to do and things that are supposed to happen.





Let's Explore!

Sally writes about her reader's superstition questions in her **mailbag*** blog.

* A "mailbag" is a large sack or bag carrying mail.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Our superstition mailbag continues. Today, I'm supposed to move on to another topic, but I decided to spend more time on the number 13, this time in relation to Friday the 13th

We have established why 13 is considered an unlucky number, but why Friday? Some writers hypothesize that Jesus was killed on a Friday, making the day unlucky. Another theory claims that Friday got its bad reputation from the book *The Canterbury Tales*, where throughout Friday is referred to as a day of misfortune. Which is true? I have no idea, but I do know some of the things you shouldn't do on Friday the 13th.

For example, on Friday the 13th, you're not supposed to travel because you will have bad luck. You are not supposed to cut your hair because if you do, someone in your family will die. Now that's a bad hair day.

Finally, being born on Friday the 13th will result in the child being unlucky for life - which for me, is just another reason to blame your parents for everything.

I tend to believe that Friday the 13th is just another day. I enjoy talking about it, but I just can't believe that Friday the 13th is an evil day. So if you'll excuse me, I have some mirrors to break and a ladder to walk under.



**Let's Practice!**

Sally isn't supposed to be superstitious!

Instructions: Select the correct answer.

1. On Friday the 13th people are not supposed to ...
 - a. cut their hair.
 - b. go to their house.
 - c. have lunch.
2. She thinks Friday 13th is ...
 - a. a good day.
 - b. a regular day.
 - c. a evil day.
3. If you cut your hair on Friday the 13th
 - a. you are supposed to have long hair in the future.
 - b. you are supposed to have a bad hair day.
 - c. someone in your family is supposed to die.

**Let's Practice!**

What an unlucky day!

Instructions: Write down the missing words. Use capital letters where necessary.

Word Bank

to walk under a ladder / Friday the 13th / unlucky /
was killed / some mirrors to break

1. Jesus _____ on a Friday, making the day _____.
2. This time I will write a blog in relation to _____.
3. I have _____.
4. I don't want _____. That's bad luck!





Extension Activity

What can and can't you do on Friday the 13th?

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Discuss with a group your feelings about Friday the 13th. Is it really a bad luck day? Have you had any bad luck on this day?
- Brainstorm with a partner all the things you can and cannot do on Friday the 13th.
- Use "supposed to" and "not supposed to" to make your sentences.
- Research on the Internet all the other dos and don'ts and compare them with yours.
- Are there any other superstitious days in your culture and are there things you are supposed to do and not do on those days?

Self-Assessment

Yes **No**

I talk about manners, customs and superstitions.

☐ ☐

I talk about my attitudes toward an action.

☐ ☐

I research information to support my opinions.

☐ ☐

I talk about things I am supposed to do and things that are supposed to happen.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- in relation to** (expression): in the context of; in connection with
e.g. I will talk about the superstition this time in relation to Friday the 13th.
- to establish** (verb): to figure out; determine
e.g. We have established why 13 is considered an unlucky number.
- to hypothesize** (verb): to form a hypothesis, or to guess based on research
e.g. Some writers hypothesize that Jesus was killed on a Friday.
- bad reputation** (noun): a negative belief or opinion that is generally held about someone or something
e.g. Another theory claims that Friday got its bad reputation from the book The Canterbury Tales.
- misfortune** (noun): bad luck
e.g. Friday is referred to as a day of misfortune.
- throughout** (preposition): in every part of
e.g. Throughout "The Canterbury Tales" Friday is referred to as a day of misfortune.
- bad hair day** (expression): A day on which everything seems to go wrong,
e.g. Now that's a bad hair day.





Learning Points

Be Supposed to

You use the structure **be supposed to** when you want to talk about expectations, obligations or arrangements.

You can use **be supposed to** to talk about situations in the past, present or future.

The structure is:

subject + to be + supposed to + verb

*You **are not supposed to** travel on Friday the 13th.*

*I **was supposed to** take a trip on Friday the 13th, but I canceled it.*

****Pronunciation tip**:**

When you say *be supposed to*, you link the /d/ and /t/ sounds together.

Like this:

Be suppose_to

Examples:

- *On Friday the 13th, you are not supposed to cut your hair.*
- *You are supposed to stay home on Friday the thirteenth.*
- *I am supposed to move on to another topic.*





Learning Points

Gerunds and Infinitives

A **gerund** is a verb ending with -ing (doing-reading-looking).

An **infinitive** is to + verb (to do – to have – to speak).

There are verbs you can use with **gerunds** and verbs you can use with **infinitives**.

Note that the **gerund** can also be used as the subject of the sentence.

These verbs are commonly followed by a **gerund**:

To express **likes** and **dislikes** :

*like**

*love**

enjoy

*hate**

Example:

*I **love reading** my fan's questions.*

- *like/love/hate* can also be followed by an infinitive.

These are some verbs that are followed by an **infinitive**:

hope

seem

decide

start

Example:

*I **hoped to discover** something interesting about Friday the 13th.*

You use **infinitives** after **adjectives**.

Example:

*She is **afraid to talk** about Friday the 13th.*

An activity can be expressed as a **gerund**- this **gerund** functions as the subject of the sentence.

Example:

***Reading** my fan mail is really interesting.*

***Writing about the Friday the 13th** was a great idea.*

